

Wherefore Putting Away Lying

Passing in review once again, looking at Hebrews 4:11, He said:

Let us labour therefore to enter into that rest, lest any man fall after the same example of unbelief.

For the word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any twoedged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, and of the joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart.

Neither is there any creature that is not manifest in His sight: but all things are naked and opened unto the eyes of Him with whom we have to do.

He said the labor we should be doing is to enter into the rest. He said this lest we fall after the same example of unbelief as the forefathers, whose carcasses fell in the desert and who did not enter into their rest, into the promised land.

But He said the labor we are supposed to be doing is the labor to enter into His rest. Then He went on to say the Word of God is alive and powerful. It is quick to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the intents of the heart.

The only thing qualified to make a clear distinction between whether a person is operating out of spirit or operating out of soul is the Word of God. This is why He labeled it as a two-edged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder. It can make such a clear cut between soul and spirit that you can walk in between the two halves, look to your left and say, "That is the operation of the soul," and look to your right and say, "That is the operation of the spirit."

The Word of God is the only qualified standard that can discern the very intents and thoughts of the heart.

We got into studying this a little bit, and the Holy Ghost has not let me vary too far from it.

We found out our inner man has spiritual hands and spiritual feet that fit into our physical hands and physical feet. But we found out more than that. We found out that within our inner man is the nature of the new creation, which contains the forces of love, peace, joy, and dominion. These forces are resident within our human spirit in the new nature of our creation.

If my inner man stepped out of my outer man and went to heaven, the force and emotions of love, joy, peace, dominion, and all these forces would go with him.

It is the same way my spiritual hand fits into my physical hand. This spiritual part of me, my spiritual soul that contains these forces of love, peace, joy, and dominion, fits into the physical soul of my anatomy, which has the emotion of love, the emotion of joy, and the emotion of happiness.

It is great when my spirit man wants to express love, and the force of love rises up and expresses itself outward through my soul, through the emotion of love.

My new creation on the inside has the force of love, the force of joy, the force of peace, and the force of dominion. This nature is stable in God. My inner man is my stabilizer. He will go up, but he will not fluctuate down. The part of me that fluctuates down is the emotional makeup of my soul that my spirit man has to operate through.

So the force of love plugs into the emotion of love. When I am feeling that love inside, I am able to enjoy the force of love because it expresses itself throughout my physical soul through the emotion of love.

The problem is that when Adam fell, he took on that death nature not only within his spirit but also in his physical soul. When he was born again, like you and I, that new nature once again stabilized the spirit.

We just have one problem. He said, "Let not therefore sin reign in your mortal body, that ye should obey it in the lusts thereof." He would not have to say, "Let not sin reign in your mortal body," if your mortal body did not have the capacity to sin.

If He had taken that nature out of my flesh the same way He took it out of my spirit when I was born again, then I would not have this contention that says:

 This I say then, Walk in the Spirit, and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.

He did not say, "Walk in the Spirit, and they will all go away." He said they would not be fulfilled in you.

So my spirit man, with love, has stabilized. But he is forced to operate through this physical soul. My physical emotions want to fluctuate. They want to go high to the heights of happiness, and then the next day they want to go to the lows of depression. My spirit does not want to go with them.

When you pray in tongues, you are bypassing the operation of the physical soul. You are throwing a lifeline to the spirit.

Even though the nature and force of love may exist in your spirit, it may be so repressed and so dominated that you hardly know it exists. It will be encased in the emotion of love, which can fluctuate between love and hate.

That little bitty force of love in your spirit is having problems operating because the church teaches more on how to operate out of the emotional realm than out of the spiritual realm. The reason they can get more results with you is because they psych you up in the natural.

Who wants to labor over prayer hour after hour? We are not real popular.

But when you pray in tongues, and that little force of love is encapsulated by the emotion of love operating in the physical soul, pretty soon that edification starts feeding that little force of love like a seed until it germinates and busts open. It grows bigger and bigger until pretty soon, instead of the emotion encapsulating the force of love, the force of love in your spirit grows so big that it encapsulates the emotion of love. It dominates the emotions of the soul instead of the soul realm dominating the forces in your spirit.

This is called taking off the old man and putting on the new.

He said the only qualified discernor to let Roberson know whether he is operating out of the flesh, the soul, or the spirit is the Word of God.

So why do you and I not take this a little further as we start discerning this?

Go to Ephesians 4:21. We will be over in Hebrews 6 in a moment. But I feel that teacher on me. I feel real slow. If we are going to learn how to operate out of the inner man as opposed to the outer man, then let us find out a little bit more about what it means to take this outer one off and put the inner one on.

Look at this very closely:

If so be that ye have heard Him, and have been taught by Him, as the truth is in Jesus:
That ye put off concerning the former conversation the old man, which is corrupt according to the deceitful lusts;
And be renewed in the spirit of your mind;
And that ye put on the new man, which after God is created in righteousness and true holiness.

Notice verse 23: "Be renewed in the spirit of your mind."

That is the same transformation He is talking about in Romans 12, when He said to offer your body a living sacrifice and be not conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, that you may prove what is first the good, then the acceptable, and then the absolute perfect will of God.

Notice that you are to be renewed in the spirit of your mind and put on the new man.

I like this:

And that ye put on the new man, which after God is created in righteousness and true holiness.

Glory to God. I am supposed to put that one on, the one created after God in true holiness. I am supposed to take the old man off in the spirit of my mind through transformation and put this one on.

Boy, now this starts to get real interesting.

Let me show you the first thing you are supposed to take off. Are you ready for this?

Before I start really harassing you, please let me assure you of your salvation. It is not by works, lest any man should boast. It is the unearnable, unmeritable favor of God bestowed on you and me.

What we could not do, He did. We had absolutely no access to God; then mercy came. We had nothing to bargain with before an omnipotent, all-powerful God, and mercy came. He had mercy on us and sent Jesus across the lost void of humanity. He closed that void with His blood and gave me something to bargain with.

The difference between mercy and grace is this: if you came home and caught a thief in your house stealing from you, you could have mercy on him and let him go. He would not have anything to bargain with. You caught him red-handed in the act, but you could have mercy on him and let him go. That is mercy.

The difference between mercy and grace is when you take that same thief, exalt him to your brother, and adopt him into your family. There is your difference.

I have been born again. His mercy crossed the void and made the blood available. When I took hold of the blood, His grace kicked in, and He made me His brother. Not by my works, lest any man should boast, but by the grace of God.

When He talks about taking off the old man and putting on the new, it has nothing to do with the righteousness He has instated in your spirit that says you are going to heaven, hell or high water.

But I will tell you what putting on the new man has to do with. It has to do with God hearing and answering your prayers.

I do not mind telling you, in seventeen years of revival, teaching faith and confession, thank God for those foundations. Teaching the walk of the Spirit, thank God. Praying in tongues and receiving mysteries, foundational truths, thank God.

For seventeen years, first I went around to my own hall meetings, then church meetings, then camp meetings, and I would return. Do you know what I found out? After all the great revelations I gave these people, when I returned they had just as much trouble getting their prayers answered as they did before I left.

As a majority, as a whole, the saints have a problem laying hold of God and getting their prayers answered. In fact, if you lined up a thousand people, gave them a deadline to believe for something, and had them pray the prayer of faith, I think you would be disgusted and discouraged by going down the line after the deadline had come and asking how many had received. You would be disappointed at the least.

I have some news for you, people. The soul realm is the emotional realm. Most of us operate out of it. Very few of us operate out of the stabilizing foundations of our spirit.

Most of us make our confessions, our bold faith statements. We set dates on things. We measure standards by operating out of the soul realm.

"I am believing five thousand dollars in by the thirtieth, three months from now."

We will confess it and do everything we know to do. Three months comes and goes, and it does not come in.

Do you know why? What is really going to happen is not what is operating out of the soul. What is really going to happen is what is operating out of the spirit.

You say, "Well, how long would it take me to believe a thousand dollars in?"

I tell you what. Do everything you know to believe it in. When it comes in, that is how long it took you to believe for it, whether you set any dates on it or not, because that is where you are.

If we can change your operation from operating out of the soul realm and put your foundation on the spirit, then you can change how you believe and how fast things will come in.

So when He talks about taking off the old man and putting on the new, yes, I am born again, but I want my prayers answered.

In my seventeen years, I found something out about my Father. Glory to God. I used to try to defend Him. He does not need it.

He proved that to me by watching the majority of believers. They will get into a crisis, and their crisis is so devastating that they abandon themselves on God. He does not do anything, and to the world it offers infallible proof once again that there is no God.

I used to think, "God, why did You not just overlook a few things, move in there, and exalt them out of their problem? Your name and reputation were at stake. Look how many people would be born again if You would just override that situation and do something."

But I found out He does not need defending. He is going to do what He does because He is God. He has standards, spiritual law, and faith. When you meet the standard, it is not His choice. Truth is truth, and He is infallible. He will move and answer your prayer.

I said, "God, You do not need me defending You."

I see so many believers in crisis. They try to coax you, coerce you, and get you involved in their situation. Yet, to the detriment of Your own reputation, they go down in a flailing array of defeat, and You just stand there and watch them. As far as I am concerned, You prove to the world one more time that You do not exist.

Do you want to know the other side of that coin? If you ever get hold of this thing, absolutely nothing will be impossible to him that believeth, because with the same ferocious integrity, He will hold His truth up for anybody who can lift it as a standard.

Hallelujah.

When He is talking about taking off the old man and putting on the new, I want you to notice the first standard, the first thing He told you and me to put off.

Watch this:

And that ye put on the new man, which after God is created in righteousness and true holiness.

Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour: for we are members one of another.

Wherefore, put away lying. Wherefore, put away lying.

Some of you are reading ahead because you want to find out what kind of trouble you are going to get in.

What is the first foundational truth? What is the first fruit of the flesh He asks you to put away? This is first in your transformation and renewing of your mind. He would not make it first in priority in putting on the new man if there were no reason to do so.

The first priority, the one He esteemed most important first, is to put away lying.

Let me give you a little hint: Roberson could not do it without the Holy Ghost.

Before we get lost in this, can I make a few more faith statements? Let us go on a little bit.

Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour: for we are members one of another.

Be ye angry, and sin not: let not the sun go down upon your wrath:

Neither give place to the devil.

I want to comment on verse 28:

Let him that stole steal no more: but rather let him labour, working with his hands the thing which is good, that he may have to give to him that needeth.

I would just like to comment on that, if you do not mind.

The more I meditated on this, the more I thought, My God, He is not talking to some guy who just held up a QuikTrip. "Let him that stole steal no more." He is instructing believers about putting off the old man and putting on the new. He is not talking to some guy in the world running around holding up QuikTrips and stealing.

It finally dawned on me what He was trying to say. Besides the foundational truth, He is talking to believers.

Let me tell you something. Do you know what He is really saying here? If you are able to work and will not, then you are stealing from the people you are living off of.

I thought this was a shouting message.

Let me tell you the other emphasis He kept pouring through my spirit. What a reason to get a job and work with your hands: to give to him that needs. He considers it thievery if you are capable of working, jobs are available, and you live off somebody else. He considered it thievery.

But the other emphasis, the reason He said "with your hands," is because He is talking about deceit, cunningness, and craftiness of the lusts of the flesh. He is talking about conniving schemes, perversions from truth, to get money out of the saints.

What He was saying in the emphasis on "work with your hands" is: quit using lies, conniving, scheming, and mishandling the truth to get rich, and go get a job and straighten that lying communication out.

Tim, do you remember when you were taking me to the airport and God started talking to me about lying?

I said, "I do not know, Tim, but lying has something to do with anger. I do not know how, because I have not got the connection and the mystery. I have been praying. But it has something to do with uncontrollable anger."

That is the anger you want to get rid of, the temper you cannot get rid of, the one that hangs with you year after year.

When He brought these verses to me in a mystery, He made the connection.

I look at this again. The first foundational thing we are supposed to lay away from us in putting on the new man is lying. He says, "Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbor, for we are members one of another."

Then He said, "Go ahead, be angry and sin not. Do not let the sun go down on your wrath."

All right. To take this a little further and talk about this anger, let us go on over to Hebrews 6. Let me show you something about God's nature.

Hebrews 6:18 says:

That by two immutable things, in which it was impossible for God to lie...

Impossible for God to lie.

The word immutable is one of the characteristic essences that makes up God's nature. There are nine essences that make up His nature. These are His characteristics. This is His essence.

Number one, God is absolute sovereignty.

Number two, He is absolute righteousness.

Number three, He is absolute judgment.

Number four, He is absolute love.

Number five, He is absolute eternal life.

Number six, He is absolute immutability.

Number seven, He is absolute omniscience, all-knowing without time.

Number eight, He is omnipotence, all-powerful without time.

Number nine, He is omnipresence. There is nowhere He is not.

These nine characteristics make up the essence of God.

For a moment, let us talk about His immutability, which means He changes not. It is absolutely impossible for God to change. He is as constant as truth. He was the same multi-billion years ago. He is the same now. He will be the same unchanging, immutable God multi-trillion years from now.

In His immutability, because He changes not, He never has lied, He never can lie, and He never will lie. He never can, has, or will represent any situation that has lies involved with it.

When a person's life is built upon a lie, you must know this immutable, unchanging characteristic of God: He cannot lie, nor can He add His essence to any foundation that is built on a lie.

In His immutability, it is impossible for Him to deceive. He is impeccable. He cannot move in any way, shape, or form that is detrimental, nor can He represent a lie. It is impossible for God to lie.

Therefore, in putting off the old man and putting on the new, the reason the first and foremost priority to put away from us is lying is because lying is the foundation of the old man. If you do not put it away, then the rest of your life will be built upon that lie and every lie to follow. Because it is impossible for God to lie, it is impossible for Him to lend Himself to you if you are living in a lie.

Now, I preached about the grace of God, did I not? Did we not talk about being the righteousness of God and being saved through the unmeritable, unearnable favor of God?

We are not talking about His mercy taking us to heaven. We are talking about the ability of our God to hear and answer your prayers.

"Take it a little further, Brother Roberson. What about those little white lies?"

What kind is that?

You know, those kinds you tell where you do not quite represent the truth. You mislead. You lead people to believe something that is not true, which you know is not true. But you know, you did not really lie. You just led them to believe something else.

But did you lie?

"No, no, I did not lie."

How about that, Brother Roberson?

All right. I will tell you about that. If you represent any situation without absolute truth, the end of that situation will be more devastating than the temporary solving of the problem that the lie represented.

Even though that is a damaging aspect, let me tell you another. If a person refuses to change his foundation and get rid of even the little bitty, tiny white lies, then he refuses the foundation of pure spirit.

The reason He said, "Blessed are the pure in heart," is because pureness of spirit signifies the man or woman who operates in total absence of deceit. That is why Jesus said, "Let your yes be yes and your no be no," because anything in between can come of evil.

Blessed are the pure in heart. They shall see God.

Any man or woman who has fought their way to a foundation of absolute pureness of spirit, no deceit, operating in total absence of deceit, has yeses that are yes and noes that are no.

Let us talk about this.

Is anybody else having as good a time as I am?

He said, "Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God." That is the man or woman who operates in total absence of deceit.

In fact, that is what Jesus said to Nathanael when He saw him under the tree. He said, "Behold, an Israelite indeed, in whom is no guile." There was no deceit in his mouth, none.

When Jesus conveyed this to Nathanael, Nathanael said, "My God, You are the Son of God."

Jesus said, "Because I told you this, you believe I am the Son of God? Nathanael, let Me tell you what you are going to see from now on. You will see angels ascending and descending upon the Son of Man."

He did not say that to any of the other disciples.

He said, "Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God."

When the Lord started jerking the slack out of me on this foundational truth, I said, "My God, what will be the end result of this?"

Do you know what He told me? He said, "Son, the end result will be this: when you pray, I will answer."

Some of you are looking down. What do you have little white lies in?

I want you to notice something. When God refers to His own Word, He does not just refer to it as His Word. It is referred to as truth as much as it is Word, because of His immutability. He cannot change, nor can He lie. So His Word is represented as absolute truth.

I do not know what your Achilles' heel is, but I do know what the Word of God says. It says the first foundational thing a person must put away in putting on the new man is all lying.

Let us talk about it a little further.

There is nobody who has handled the Word of God and used it in the realms of confession and setting standards like faith people. We have done so, representing it as the infallible Word of God, as absolute standard, truth, and foundation to build our lives upon.

But we really do not understand what we are doing and the standard He has set when He gave us the Word of God to use. The reason so many people who try to use the Word fall short is because somewhere in their lives they threw sand into their foundation. In impurity they deceive, mishandle, and misrepresent truth.

In doing so, they deceive their own heart and cannot even understand the standard God put on His own Word, because they do not have that standard in their own heart.

Until you say, "I am going to put the new man on," until you say, "I am putting my feet on the solid rock of doing His sayings, and I am going to represent truth in its purest form; I do not care what it costs me. I do not care if it costs me a fortune, my house, my living, or extenuating circumstances. I do not care if bending the truth a little bit would save my life."

Until you adopt a standard of truth with this ferociousness, with this priority, my friend, until you stand there and say, "As I see this truth to be, I am going to represent it. I do not care what it costs me. I know I could misrepresent the truth just a little bit, just a teeny bit, and I would get off and things would..."

No.

Because you throw sand in your foundation. And once again, my friend, in His immutability, His unchanging character, it is impossible for Him to lie. If it is impossible for Him to lie, it is impossible for Him to join Himself to your lie, no matter how minute it is.

"But I did it to keep from hurting somebody's feelings."

A lie is a lie.

"But it was out of pureness of heart."

A lie is a lie, and the final end will be more devastating than the handling of the truth in pureness, love, and a meek spirit.

God cannot lend Himself to that thing because in His immutability He cannot lie. He cannot compromise. He cannot lend Himself to the sand that is in your foundation.

You will not even understand the confession of faith until you are willing to resist, and I mean resist, even the tiniest taking or misbending of the truth as though it were your destruction, as though it were your end.

When you are willing to stand there and represent truth over the tiniest, most minute, insignificant untruth, when you are willing to take your stand and represent the truth in that situation no matter what it costs you, then, my friend, you are approaching an understanding of the integrity in God's own Word.

If His Word then abides in you, and you in Him, you can ask what you will, and it shall be done.

Yes, preach on, Brother Roberson. Some of us might need it too.

In my own life, breaking that lying spirit was about the hardest thing I ever did.

I entered into my born-again experience with a righteous spirit and a boatload of insecurities and intimidations that came from my childhood. I am not a psychiatrist, but I know that when my ma would bring home these alcoholics, and they were the only daddies I really knew, I would try to get them to take me fishing, and they were not interested.

Finally we went to live with Grandpa. He did not like me in one sense because I reminded him of old man Roberson, who had been in armed robbery and spent most of his life in prison.

Every time I did something wrong, Grandpa would scream at me, "You are no good. You are never going to amount to anything. You are just like your old man Roberson."

It intimidated me so much that if he told me to pick something up, I was just a kid, it could be right in front of me, and I could not see it.

He would say, "Pick that hammer up and give it to me."

He would be on the ladder, and I could not see it. It could be the only thing on the table, and I would panic. I could not see it. He would come storming down off the ladder and kick me so hard my teeth would rattle. Then he would scream at me about old man Roberson and how I was going to be no good.

So I had panic, and I was intimidated around any kind of authority.

When I was born again, it was in ultra-holiness. We were very legalistic. I was used to God being mean to me. He was like my other father: if I did anything wrong, He would break my car or take one of my kids and make them sick to teach me my lesson.

When I entered into my born-again walk, the hardest thing for me to lay aside was lying. It took me years.

When a person is a habitual liar, it is generally a sign of a much, much deeper problem. It is real easy to misrepresent the truth because you can transform yourself before anybody's eyes into the sparkling champion, the kind of hero you know you should be.

So it was easy to misrepresent the truth, and I did. I misrepresented, or I just plain lied.

I know now that I wanted to be accepted. I wanted people to like me, so I would lie about it.

I finally told my wife after I was born again, "When I exaggerate too badly or lie, call me down."

So she called me down.

I said, "Do it in front of everybody. I will learn."

So she called me down. I mean, not while I was preaching, but in a little group of people. I made this statement, and it was a bald-faced lie, I guess, an exaggeration. She called me down, and I got mad at her.

A person lies because he does not want to appear to somebody to be what he is. We will be lazy, cover things up, not get it done, and yet we said we would. We promised, and our character flaws take over.

What do we do? We bend it a little.

"Oh, you know, I kind of got busy."

You did not get busy, you lying outfit. You could have gotten it done.

"Hey, are you going to the meeting tonight, sis?"

"I was really looking forward to going, but something came up."

Then you get on the phone and say, "Invite me to dinner. I do not want to go to the meeting."

Well, something came up, did it not?

So what did you do? You lied.

"Well, I did not want to hurt their feelings."

You do not have to hurt their feelings, but for God's sake, represent the truth.

"Are you going tonight?"

"No. No, I do not think I am going to go tonight."

If they press you, "Do you have a reason that you are not going to go?"

"Yes, I have a reason, but I would rather not tell you."

"Well, I want you to tell me."

"Okay. I do not like your preaching. Sit down."

This is where I ran into my problems from my lying past. I did not want my wife to know I was that hideous creature she married before I was born again. I wanted to be the knight in shining armor to my wife.

So she would say, "Did you? Did you?"

"No, no, no."

"Well, did you?"

"No, not me. Me, I am a hard worker, morning till night, not like these kids nowadays. My God."

Then I started this fasting and praying, these long lengths of time in the Holy Ghost. That bright light began to shine on the things in my life hidden in darkness. Those foundational lies I had spoken began to bother me, because every time I would hear my wife talk to somebody, she would build on my lie.

"Well, my husband never did that."

I was sitting there thinking, I did it, but I lied to her in the past. I am not lying now, but that is a lie she keeps building on. I am going to have to tell her. My God, she took my lie and spread it all over because I did not want to tell her the truth.

So I was up in my office, all beat up. I said, "Donna, come here. Donna, go get me a cup of coffee."

She said, "Are you tired?"

I said, "Yes, I have really been through it."

She said, "What have you been doing?"

I said, "I have been cut up and butchered and everything. Oh God, I have been run through a wringer."

I had been establishing my foundation on pureness of spirit. By golly, if there is one standard I want to raise higher than any standard I have ever raised, it is the absolute, total absence of deceit and lying in the handling of the truth in all pureness of spirit.

Because of His immutability, it is impossible for Him to lie. When He can add Himself to my life absolutely, with no lies or misrepresentation of the truth, I can pray and He will answer.

So it took a lot of praying in the Holy Ghost. The Holy Ghost shined light on those things hidden in darkness. They started bothering me.

Now, in closing here, I am going to say this. If any of you come up and ask me about my past, it is none of your business what my old man did. You are not building on my lie. It is absolutely none of your business. I will tell you that.

Anything I did after I was born again, if I lied and sinned, that is between me and my Father. That is none of your business either. So rather than lie to you, what you are going to get is, "It is none of your business."

He says, "Put away lying, for you are members one of another. Be angry and sin not. Do not let the sun set on your wrath."

If a person is representing a mistruth, if you have built yourself up to be something you are not, then you will keep that anger. You will keep a temper to defend something that is not true.

That is why He says, "Do not give place to the devil." If you are in deceit and mishandling truth in any situation, then you crack a little hole for the devil. He will go in there and keep a temper active in you because you will want to defend the man you created who you are not.

That is where anger gets its control from.

When He says, "Be angry, and sin not," He is talking about representing righteousness. He is talking about the kind of anger, righteous indignation, where somebody comes and accuses this or that, and you stand up, no matter what it costs you. You get angry, and you represent truth.

How many of you have ever gotten angry in righteous defense of the truth, then went to bed that night with peace because you got mad enough to stand up with no deceit and represent the absolute truth?

"Be angry," He said, "and sin not."

How is it? Any of you? No?

But it is absolutely impossible for God to lie. When you do not represent the truth in the absence of deceit, you throw sand in your foundation. When you throw sand in your foundation, it is impossible for God to join Himself to it.

You may psych yourself up: "We are going to enter into this business. I will tell you what, we are going to enter in so we can give millions to Christians, millions."

Really, the guy has dollar signs in his own eyes. He psychs himself up and lies to himself, and he knows it. He knows he is using God for leverage. He knows it.

Then later, when the business gets in trouble and he prays, it is not based on truth. It is based on a lie, and God will not join Himself to it.

Has anybody been tortured today?

What do you think it is worth to raise your hand and say, "Father, I know that You hear me always," and have Him hear and answer your prayer?

Yes, everything.

I have never seen you so quiet.

"What if I told what I thought was the truth?"

That is pure in heart. If you thought you told the truth, then if you did not tell it but thought you did, it does not make any difference. It is the intent of the heart. In order to deceive, you have to have the intention.

This is one of the greatest times of my life.

In closing now, I have often wondered what happened to Kathryn Kuhlman sometime after the point that she married Mr. and bawled and cried and made up her mind that God would not let her get by with her marriage to Mr. She testified with her own mouth that she loved Mr. more than God, more than life itself at one point.

Yet Kathryn Kuhlman took Mr. away from another woman. He divorced the woman. He divorced his family and kids and went off with Kathryn and married her.

She said, "Oh, I loved Mr. I loved him more than life."

He would preach, and she would sit back behind the platform and bawl and cry. She said, "I know God let other people get by with it. I was hoping He would let me."

The day came when Mr. put her on the train, and she said, "I have come to a place where I know God is not letting me get by with this. I cannot go on anymore this way."

Mr. put her on the train and said, "Kathryn, if you leave, you will never hear from me again in a hindering way to your ministry, ever."

Something happened from that day she was put on the train, when she reestablished her foundation. Something happened. I never quite understood what, but I know somewhere Kathryn came to an end of herself right after Mr., because that great ministry God gave her began.

Sometime after that, at the end of her ministry, when she had invitations from princesses and kings from around the world, the secretary brought one single envelope in. It had two hearts with one arrow, and the door was left a little open.

Mr. had a code name. She opened it up. It was on Valentine's Day. She read it. She did not read it out loud, but her secretary was watching her through the door. Kathryn put the Valentine's card down, lifted her hands, and said, "Father, no one, no one could know what this ministry has cost me."

She loved him. Yet somewhere after Mr., Kathryn came to the end of herself. She died to give up so much. She had to have rebuilt her entire foundation in absolute purity, no deceit, in the handling of the truth.

It has taken me seventeen years to come here, but I now understand that it had to have been the same revelation that set Kathryn free. If you will work on it and rebuild your foundation, it will be the same revelation that sets you free.

Because when you pray, He will answer.

He will come as the immutable God, not just lending Himself to you as strength to overcome situations and to be with you through all your problems as He is God. He will come on the pureness of your foundation with His immutability, and He cannot lie.

He will come in pureness of spirit, pick you up in that foundation, anoint you, and give to you. All the restraints will be taken off.

For if My Word lives in you and you abide in Me, it is one thing for me to understand and know His Word by revelation, but it is another thing for Jesus to come forth and me to live in Him.

He said, "You can ask what you will, and it shall be done."

You wonder where so many prayers are lost in the saints and the masses, and why He can stand and watch crises and people go down when He could offer infallible proof that He is God. But He is immutable. He changes not, and He cannot lie.

So when you finally get hold of this thing, and your life takes on this integrity, and you uphold the truth with the same standard that He is, which is truth, then absolutely nothing will be impossible for you. You can believe for anything.

See, we cannot take the same standard that is not working. I am not ashamed of rebuilding my foundation. I am not ashamed at all. I thank God for revelation knowledge.

Until you resist lying, mishandling truth, deceiving, and misrepresenting, until you resist it with everything in you, no matter what it costs you, we are not going to understand the standard He puts on truth and on the confession of the Word.

His truth is so solid and forever settled in heaven and earth. God is not deciding to move in your situation. He is not looking down and saying, "Will I or will I not?" His Word is truth. It is a standard. He can do nothing else but move.

But if your life is built on a lie, then truth cannot add itself to a lie. Bitter and sweet water cannot flow from the same fountain. They can, but one neutralizes the other.

If you want Him to join Himself to you, answer your prayers, and set your standard, make a decision to begin walking out of it tonight. I am going to tell you what, it is going to take a little while.

We are so programmed with pat answers of how the hero is supposed to be that we will throw that pat answer out before we stop and give the truth. I have heard people say, "Brother Roberson, I thought everybody did that."

That is why the majority's prayers are not answered. They do.

If I start prying into your life and you do not want to talk about it, rather than lie, tell me it is none of my business. Then you can throw a few multiples in there so I will not guess which one it is.

You can be angry. Get mad. Get mad about it. Represent the truth, and do not let the sun set on your wrath. If you do, then you will give place to the devil, and he will represent that old man you do not want to die.

Let him die.

The devil's whole nature is a liar. He is going to have problems using you.

I am just glad that for the last two days He has had me under the gun and had one of those straightedges out on me.

When I pray, He hears me.

"Did He use you with your faults?"

Oh God, yes, He did. There have been times everybody I prayed for got something, got healed and all that. Then I would go home, and when it came to my prayers, forget it. He was not answering them.

But now He has joined Himself to me.

Close your eyes.

He says if a man walks in darkness and says he has no sin, the truth is not in him. He lies. And He says if you will confess it as sin, He is faithful and just to forgive you and cleanse you from all sin.

He is talking about a man walking in deceit and deception who says, "I do not have any." But if we ask the Advocate, Jesus Christ the righteous, our law, our go-between, standard-setter, truth, He said He will cleanse us from all unrighteousness, and your slate will be swept clean.

If the rung of the ladder, if the bottom step is a lie, then sometimes you have to go back and replace the bottom step. That is where it hurts.

But if you refuse to represent the bottom rung anymore, do it.